

English

Stage 9

Paper 1 Non-fiction

2024

Cambridge Lower Secondary Progression Test

Insert

Text for **Section A**, an extract from *The History of Sneakers* by Naomi Braithwaite

The humble sneaker: a symbol of our times

Your best foot forward

Sneakers (or trainers if you're British!), once a symbol of athleticism, have transcended their primary function to become commercial and fashionable objects of desire. From sportswear and street style to catwalk fashion, sneakers have made their mark as the most sought-after commodities. 5

The global sneaker market, valued at approximately US\$79 billion in 2020, is predicted to reach US\$120 billion by 2026. With such huge growth, it is unsurprising that they are considered BIG business. Such are the strides in the sneaker industry that the shoe has become the undisputed cultural symbol of our times. 10

Comfort is king

The last couple of decades have seen a huge shift in how sneakers are worn. Donning a pair is no longer frowned upon in the workplace and they are even becoming socially acceptable on more formal occasions. 15

The continued dominance of the athleisure trend has had a significant impact on the growing sales of sneakers – along with the pursuit of comfort. This has grown in recent years with more people working from home and prioritising comfort, resulting in higher sales of loungewear, athleisure and flat shoes, like sneakers.

As such, sneakers have moved from being niche products to become coveted as fashionable objects. Footwear is now the biggest-selling category in the online luxury market and sneakers have made a significant contribution to this growth. 20

Popularity of outdoor pursuits

The earliest sports shoes were created in the middle of the 19th century when it was discovered that canvas uppers could be bonded to rubber soles. Known as sandshoes, they caught on with the increasing popularity of outdoor leisure pursuits such as beach excursions. By the end of the 19th century, sporting activities had become popular, in particular lawn tennis, resulting in the need for more specialised shoes. Around 1892, the US Rubber Company developed rubber and canvas shoes called keds. By 1917, keds – or sneakers as they became known – began to be mass produced. (They got their nickname because the rubber soles were so quiet compared to other contemporary shoes.) 25 30

From tennis to track

Two companies shaped the sneaker's evolution from tennis to track shoe. The first company, founded by Adi Dassler in Germany in 1924 and which later became known as Adidas, utilised canvas and rubber to develop light-weight spiked running shoes. In 1936, sprinter Jesse Owens wore Dassler's spikes at the Olympics. Following Owens' four gold medals, Dassler shoes became renowned in the sporting world. They soon became the most popular athletic shoe globally and business boomed. 35

The second company to shape the sneaker's future was Nike Inc. In 1972, Nike's first commercial design, the Cortez, was a cushioned running shoe. The public demand for this shoe surged after its use by the US Olympic athletes. Coinciding with a running craze across America, Nike sales reached US \$800 000 in the first year of release. 40

Contemporary to cool

During the first half of the 20th century, sports shoes were worn mostly to play sports. But in the 1950s, teens in America began wearing them as fashion statements. This fad really took off after James Dean appeared in sneakers in the cult teenage movie *Rebel Without a Cause* (1955). 45

The popularity of sneakers soared again in the 70s and 80s with the emergence of the hip-hop music scene. Famous rappers such as Public Enemy made brightly coloured tracksuits and sneakers all the rage. Then, with the launch of Nike Air Jordans in 1984, sneakers were not only fashionable but became desirable status items – a phenomenon boosted by celebrity endorsements. Over the next four decades, new technologies developed from advances in space technology were used to help improve the performance of sneakers. One brand of sneaker, as well as being super light-weight and durable, had air pumped into them to make them fit more snugly. In another brand, little pockets of gas were added to create better cushioning. Of course, innovations like these come at a cost: athletic shoes have shot up in price! 50 55

The commercialisation of cool

In the 2020s, sneakers continue to grow in popularity. This is due, in part, to the resell culture. The rise of ‘sneakerheads’, people who collect and trade sneakers, has ensured that they maintain cult status. How does this work? Well, big brands routinely release limited edition shoes associated with a celebrity, hip-hop star or athlete. You would not believe the lengths people go to to get their hands on a pair of these rare shoes! And with good reason. They have a retail value of between US\$190 and US\$240 but are reselling for between US\$1695 to US\$6118. This lucrative sneaker resale market has created new kinds of sneaker enthusiasts who are generating significant hype along with personal income. 60 65

From sport to fashion, sneakers dominate today’s consumer market. Yet remarkably, despite mainstream adoption, sneakers retain their coolness as cultural icons.

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English

Stage 9

Paper 1 Non-fiction

2024

1 hour 10 minutes

Additional materials: Insert

INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer **all** questions.
- Write your answer to each question in the space provided.
- You should pay attention to punctuation, spelling and handwriting.

INFORMATION

- The total mark for this paper is 50.
- The number of marks for each question or part question is shown in brackets [].
- Suggestions for how long to spend on each section are given in the booklet.

Section A: Reading

Spend 35 minutes on this section.

Read the **text**, an article about the history of sneakers, in the insert, and answer Questions 1–10.

1 Look at lines 4–11.

(a) Give **one** word or phrase from the text that describes the original purpose of sneakers.

..... [1]

(b) Explain the meaning of *strides* as it is used here and why it is appropriate in the context of the article.

Meaning here:

Appropriate in this article because:

..... [2]

2 Look at lines 13–22. Give **one** word which means 'putting on'.

..... [1]

3 Look at lines 24–31.

(a) What was the breakthrough which led to the production of casual footwear?

..... [1]

(b) Why are dashes (–) used here? Tick (✓) **one** box.

to give an example

☐

to give the exact name

☐

to give extra information

☐

to give a simpler explanation

☐

[1]

(c) What impact does the writer create by using dashes instead of brackets?

..... [1]

4 Look at lines 33–42.

(a) What does the verb *shaped* mean as it is used here?

..... [1]

(b) Give **one** verb from the text which means 'made effective use of'.

..... [1]

5 Look at lines 59–68. Why is '*sneakerheads*' in inverted commas?

..... [1]

6 (a) What literary feature has the writer used in each of the subheadings? Tick (✓) **one** box.

metaphor	☐
oxymoron	☐
alliteration	☐
assonance	☐

[1]

(b) What overall effect does the writer create by using the same literary technique in each of the subheadings?

..... [1]

7 Give **two** features of informal language used in the text. Give a quotation from the text to support your answer.

Feature of informal language 1:

Quotation 1:

Feature of informal language 2:

Quotation 2:

[4]

- 8 In the first section (Your best foot forward), sneakers are described as *fashionable objects of desire* (line 5). This idea is repeated throughout the text. Complete the table below with quotations from the text giving a similar idea from different sections.

Section	Quotation
Your best foot forward	<i>fashionable objects of desire</i>
Comfort is king	
Contemporary to cool	
The commercialisation of cool	

[3]

- 9 Look at lines 33–42. How did the Olympics influence the development of sneakers? Write a summary of the main events in no more than **40 words**.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

[2]

10 Do you think fashionable sneakers are worth the money people pay for them? Tick (✓) **one** box.

Yes

☐

No

☐

Explain your answer by giving **two** reasons. Support each reason with evidence from the text.

Reason 1:

Evidence 1:

Reason 2:

Evidence 2:

[4]

Section B: Writing

Spend 35 minutes on this section.

- 11** Your English teacher has asked you to write an article for your school website describing how your experience of learning at school has changed over the years.

You should consider:

- ways of learning (individually, pairs, groups)
- how your teachers work and interact with students
- homework (the type and amount)
- your targets/goals.

Space for your plan:

Write your article on the next page.

[25 marks]

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Cambridge Lower Secondary Progression Test

2024

Text for **Section A**, an extract from *Where the Crawdads Sing* by Delia Owens

Kya, a young girl, is having to attend school for the first time.

Kya sat down fast in her seat at the back of the room, trying to disappear like a bark beetle blending into the furrowed trunk of an oak. Yet, as the teacher continued the lesson, she leaned forward, waiting to learn what came after twenty-nine. So far all Miss Arial had talked about was something called phonics, and the students, their mouths shaped like O's, echoed her sounds of ah, aa, o, and u, all of them moaning like doves. 5

About eleven o'clock the warm-buttery smell of baking yeast rolls and pie pastry filled the halls and seeped into the room. Kya's stomach panged and fitted, and when the class finally formed a single file and marched into the cafeteria, her mouth was full of saliva. Copying the others, she picked up a tray, a green plastic plate, and flatware¹. A large window with a counter opened into the kitchen and laid out before her was an enormous enamel pan of chicken pie crisscrossed with thick, crispy pastry, hot gravy bubbling up. A tall black woman, smiling and calling some of the kids by name, plopped a big helping of pie on her plate, then some peas in butter and a yeast roll. She got banana pudding and her own small red-and-white carton of milk to put on her tray. 10 15

She turned into the seating area, where most of the tables were full of kids laughing and talking. She recognized Chase Andrews and his friends, who had nearly knocked her off the sidewalk with their bikes, so she turned her head away and sat at an empty table. Several times in quick succession, her eyes betrayed her and glanced at the boys, the only faces she knew. But they, like everyone else, ignored her. 20

Kya stared at the pie full of chicken, carrots, potatoes, and little peas. Golden brown pastry on top. Several girls, dressed in full skirts fluffed out wide with layers of crinolines², approached. One was tall, skinny, and blond, another round with chubby cheeks. Kya wondered how they could climb a tree or even get in a boat wearing those big skirts. Certainly couldn't wade for frogs; wouldn't even be able to see their own feet. 25

As they neared, Kya stared at her plate. What would she say if they sat next to her? But the girls passed her by, chirping like birds, and joined their friends at another table. For all the hunger in her stomach, she found her mouth had gone dry, making it difficult to swallow. So after eating only a few bites, she drank all the milk, stuffed as much pie as she could into the milk carton, carefully so nobody would see her do it, and wrapped it and the roll in her napkin. 30

The rest of the day, she never opened her mouth. Even when the teacher asked her a question, she sat mute. She reckoned she was supposed to learn from them, not them from her. Why put maself up for being laughed at? she thought.

At the last bell, she was told the bus would drop her three miles from her lane because the road was too sandy from there, and that she had to walk to the bus every morning. On the way home, as the bus swayed in deep ruts and passed stretches of cord grass, Tallskinnyblonde and Roundchubbycheeks, the girls at lunch, called out, 'Where ya been, marsh hen? Where's yo' hat, swamp rat?' 35

The bus finally stopped. The driver cranked the door open, and Kya scooted out and ran for nearly half a mile, heaved for breath, then jogged all the way to their lane. She didn't stop at the shack but ran full out through the palmettos³ to the lagoon and down the trail that led through dense, sheltering oaks to the ocean. She broke out onto the barren beach, the sea opening its arms wide, the wind tearing loose her braided hair as she stopped at the tide line. She was as near to tears as she had been the whole day. 40 45

Above the roar of pounding waves, Kya called to the birds. The ocean sang bass, the gulls sang soprano. Shrieking and crying, they circled over the marsh and above the sand as she threw piecrust and yeast rolls onto the beach. Legs hanging down, heads twisting, they landed.

A few birds pecked gently between her toes, and she laughed from the tickling until tears streamed down her cheeks, and finally great, ragged sobs erupted from that tight place below her throat. The gulls squatted on the beach around her and went about their business of preening their gray extended wings. So she sat down too and wished she could gather them up and take them with her to sleep... a fluffy bunch of warm, feathered bodies.

50

Glossary:

¹flatware: cutlery

²crinolines: a stiff undergarment to hold out a skirt

³palmettos: low-growing palm trees

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English

Stage 9

Paper 2 Fiction

2024

1 hour 10 minutes

Additional materials: Insert

INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer **all** questions.
- Write your answer to each question in the space provided.
- You should pay attention to punctuation, spelling and handwriting.

INFORMATION

- The total mark for this paper is 50.
- The number of marks for each question or part question is shown in brackets [].
- Suggestions for how long to spend on each section are given in the booklet.

Section A: Reading

Spend 35 minutes on this section.

Read the **text** in the insert, and answer Questions 1 to 8.

1 Look at the first paragraph (lines 3–7).

- (a) In the first sentence, what literary technique does the writer use to describe how Kya feels?
Tick (✓) **one** box.

simile

☐

hyperbole

☐

metaphor

☐

assonance

☐

[1]

- (b) What does this sentence tell the reader about how Kya is feeling?

..... [1]

2 Look at the second paragraph (lines 8–16).

- (a) What does the verb *seeped* tell the reader about the smell?

..... [1]

- (b) Give **one** phrase that shows how hungry Kya is.

..... [1]

- (c) Look at lines 11 to 16.

How does the writer use sentence structure to build up a lot of detail?

..... [1]

3 Look at the third paragraph (lines 17–21). What does the writer mean by *her eyes betrayed her*?

..... [1]

4 Look at lines 27–34.

(a) Why does the writer use questions here?

..... [1]

(b) Why does the writer use an alternative word instead of 'myself' in the second question?

..... [1]

5 (a) Look at lines 35–45.

Which phrase shows the bus route was along a rough track?

..... [1]

(b) On the bus, Kya recognises two girls from school. How does the way she refers to these girls when she sees them on the bus link back to the information in the fourth paragraph (lines 22–26)?

Fourth paragraph:

On the bus:

[2]

(c) What makes Kya want to run away from the bus?

..... [1]

(d) When Kya arrives at the beach, her mood lifts. Explain how the writer uses personification to show this. Give a quotation to support your answer.

Explanation:

Quotation:

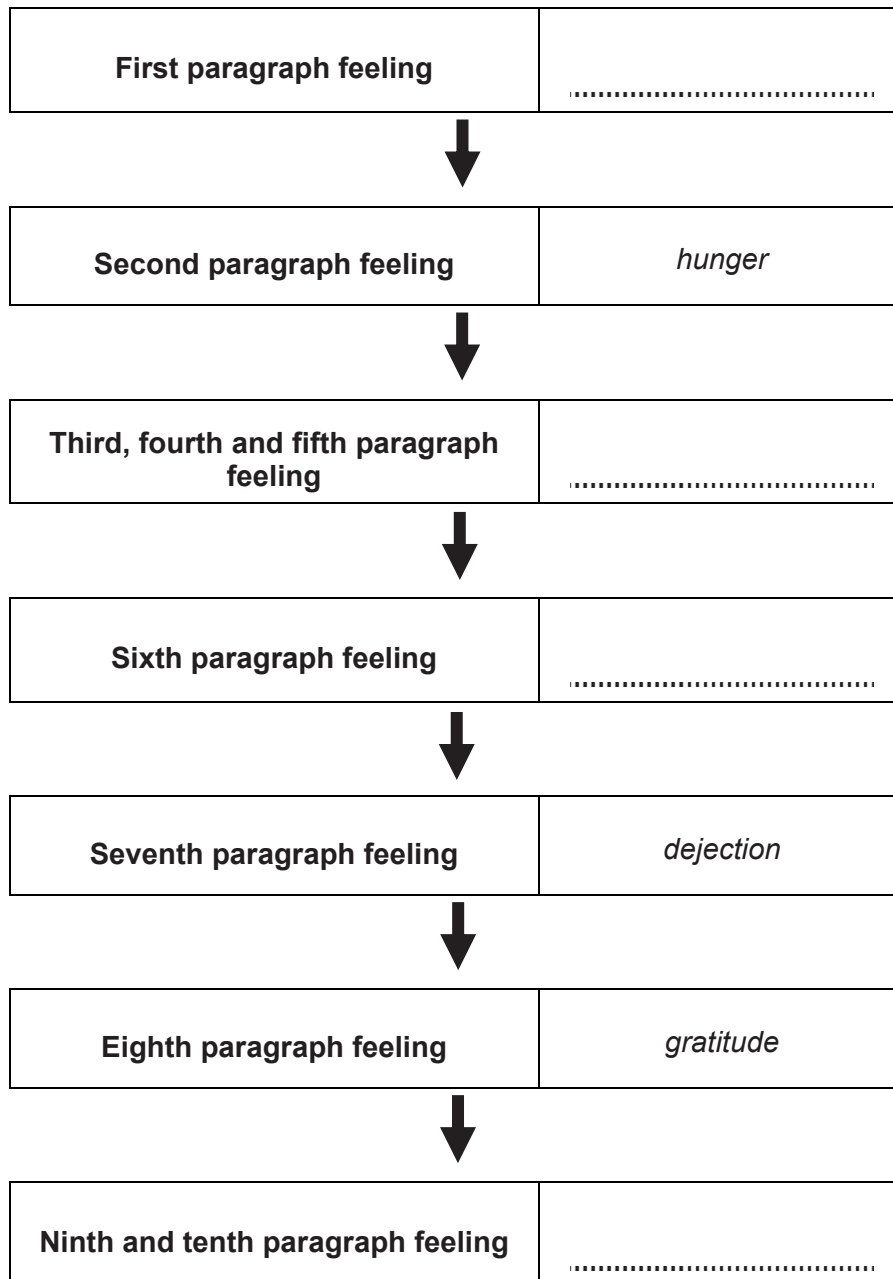
[2]

6 Look at the final two paragraphs (lines 46–53). The writer shows that there is a musical harmony in nature's sounds. Give **one** sentence from the text that emphasises this.

..... [1]

- 7 The structure of the text reflects Kya's feelings at different stages during her first day at school. Complete the flow chart by choosing **one** word from the box to summarise her feelings at each stage during the day. Three examples have been done for you. There is one extra word in the box you do **not** need to use.

isolation	defiance	interest	release	wonder
-----------	----------	----------	---------	--------



[4]

- 8 Explain how the writer shows that Kya does not fit in at school because of her different background. Give **three** ideas and support each idea with a quotation from the text.

Idea 1:

Quotation 1:

Idea 2:

Quotation 2:

Idea 3:

Quotation 3:

[6]

Section B: Writing

Spend 35 minutes on this section.

- 9** Write a story called My First Day.

It could be about your first day on a new team, or on vacation, or at a new club.

You should think about:

- Did your first day go well? Why / why not?
- Who did you meet?
- How did you feel?

Space for your plan:

Write your story on the next page.

[25 marks]

[illegible]

.....